Function of Cartilage in the Trachea

Exam code: 0610 & 0970

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Function of Cartilage in the Trachea: Extended

Extended Tier Only

- Rings of **cartilage** surround the trachea (and bronchi)
- The function of the cartilage is to **support the airways** and **keep them open** during breathing
- If they were not present then the sides could collapse inwards when the air pressure inside the tubes drops

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